



St Patrick's Belfast

FOUNDED 1815

PARISH BULLETIN

Sunday 27 September 2026

Twenty Sixth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Fr Francis O'Brien

CONTACTS

Parish Office: 028 90 324597

Address: 199 Donegall Street, Belfast, BT1 2FL

Emergency Telephone: 07496818511.

Office hours 10.30am – 2.00pm Tuesday -Thursday, closes 1pm on Friday.

You can contact us by telephone or email. Since St Patrick's is a very busy Parish Office; we can't always answer the phone immediately. Please leave a message with your telephone number and we will call you back.

Parish email: stpatricks@downandconnor.org

Website: www.stpatricks.org

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St Patrick's Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes comprising the Parishes of Holy Family, St Gerards and St Patrick's.

Holy Family – Fr Michael Spence, Fr John O' Lavery (028 90 743119)

St Gerards – Fr Patrick O'Keeffe (028 90 774833)

Belfast Jesuit Centre: Fr Gerry Clarke SJ
gclarke@jesuit.ie

St Patrick's Primary School: 028 90 351478

Blessed Trinity College: 028 90 370665

WEEKEND MASS

Saturday Vigil 6pm. Sunday Morning 9am & 11am.
Sunday Evening 6pm Candlelit Mass.

WEEKDAY MASS Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday 10am.

CONFESSIONS Saturdays 5.30pm to 5.50pm.

REST IN PEACE

Mary Campbell.

Inurnment: Joe Hayes.



MASS INTENTIONS FOR THE COMING WEEK

Saturday 6pm: Maura Connor 1st Anniversary.

Sunday 9am: Margaret and Daniel Campbell Anniversaries.

Sunday 11am: Paul Carey 1st Anniversary.

Sunday 6pm: Mary McDermott 5th Anniversary.

Tuesday 10am: Kathleen English 12th Anniversary.

Wednesday 10am: In Memory of Elizabeth and Gerard Hackett.

Thursday 10am: Maureen McKiernan Anniversary.

FEAST/MEMORIAL DAYS THIS WEEK

Tuesday 29 September

Sts Michael, Gabriel and Raphael, Archangels.

Gabriel brought the message to Mary of the Annunciation

(Patron of telecommunications, radio and TV workers). **Raphael**, guide to Tobias (patron of nurses, physicians, the blind). **Michael** has been venerated as a protector of Christians in general and soldiers in particular (patron of radiologists, the sick).

Thursday 1 October - St Therese of Lisieux

St Therese of the Child Jesus, virgin and doctor of the Church. Marie Francois Therese Martin died at the Carmel in Lisieux on 30 September 1897. She was declared a Doctor of the Church by Pope John Paul II in 1997. Patron of missions, florists, aviators and France.



St Vincent de Paul **028 90351561**

NEW LODGE GROTTTO ROSARY

Rosary at the Lourdes Grotto in the New Lodge every Monday at 7pm and Thursday at 7.30pm. All welcome.

HOLY FAMILY PARISH

Present an **Evening of Music in Holy Family Church** in aid of **Newington Day Centre**. Featuring Neil Martin, Cavehill Community Choir and Friends,

Sunday 4 October 7pm.

Tickets £10 available from Holy Family Parish Office.

TWENTY SIXTH SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

The Two Sons

The parable of the two sons was addressed to the chief priests and elders of the people. Its purpose was to defend Jesus' invitation of sinners and outcasts to the Kingdom, in the face of the sneers of the religious establishment. The parable outraged the religious people.

The first son represents sinners. Like him they originally chose to go their own way but then repented and took God's way, and so gained entry into the Kingdom. The second son represents the chief priests and elders. Like him they promised to work for God but failed to do so, and so have excluded themselves from the Kingdom. The theme of sin and repentance is also dealt with in the First Reading. The parable also echoes a favourite theme of Matthew: the split in the religious person between saying and doing. Hence, its relevance for 'religious people' in every age.

READINGS: First Reading (Ezek 18:25-28). Each of us is responsible for his or her own conduct, and will be judged accordingly. Second Reading (Phil 2:1-5). Self-seeking and rivalry have no place in the Christian community. We must imitate the humility of Christ. Gospel (Mt 2:28-32). Actions speak louder than words.

OUR LADY'S ROSARY FESTIVAL

Our Lady's Rosary Festival will take place from **12 to 18 October 2026**. Join us for a week of events to honour Our Blessed Lady, ending with the annual Belfast Rosary Procession. The procession will leave St Malachy's Church, Belfast City Centre, at 2.30pm on Sunday 18 October, and finish at St Peter's Cathedral. A full list of events can be found on the poster at the back of the Church and online at belfastrosaryfestival.com

PATHWAYS ADULT FAITH DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

The Pathways Adult Faith Development programme for 2026-2027 begins on **Saturday 10 October** at Drumalis in Larne. The programme takes place one Saturday a month from 10 am – 4 pm between October and June and is offered in-house at Drumalis. All are welcome. To find out more about the programme and the themes for each day, please **contact Drumalis (Mon-Fri, 9am-5 pm)** **028 28276455/28272196** or email drumalis@btconnect.com

JESUIT CENTRE EVENTS

Poetry & Presence begins on **Thursday 1 October** at **7pm** in the Belfast Jesuit Centre, opening with the theme of **Water** in this Season of Creation.

ST PATRICK'S PRIMARY SCHOOL – WELCOMING THE NEW SCHOOL YEAR MASS

To start off the new school year Fr Francis will celebrate a school mass in the Church on **Monday 28 September** at **10am**. All parents, grandparents, family, friends and parishioners are welcome to join us here in St Patrick's Church as we pray for God's Blessing on their new school journey.

PRAYER OF THE WEEK

PRAYER TO ST THERESE

*O little St. Therese of the Child Jesus,
please pick for me a rose
from the heavenly gardens
and send it to me as a message of love.
O little flower of Jesus,
ask God today to grant the favours
I now place with confidence in your hands.
[mention your request here]
St. Therese, help me to always believe
as you did, in God's great love for me,
so that I might imitate your "Little Way"
each day.
Amen.*

THOUGHT FOR THE WEEK

*"Your time is limited, so don't waste it living
someone else's life."*

PARISH COLLECTIONS

The Offertory Collection for Sunday 20 September came to **£1575.00**. Dona **£70.00**.

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The Autumn Voluntary Collection came to **£739.00**. Dona **£10.00**.

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If you wish to donate directly via Bank Transfer the parish bank details are:

Account Name: St Patricks Parish

Account Number: 70327727

Sort Code: 95-06-79 (please add an identifying name to your transaction) or you can contact the Parish Office for a Standing Order Form.

Thank you for your continued support and generosity.